Coaching Codex



COACHING CODEX · GUIDE 05 · CHATGPT & LLM PROMPTING FOR BUSINESS

Build Your First Custom AI Assistant: GPT, Gem or Project

Stop repeating yourself. Write clear instructions once, add a short facts file, test it with known answers, and get an assistant that already knows your business.

6	5	1
instruction parts	test questions	tested assistant

START HERE

Stop explaining your business to AI every single day.

If you paste the same 'I run a bakery in Austin, keep it friendly, prices in USD...' paragraph into AI again and again, you are ready for a custom assistant. Set it up once with instructions and a few files, and every chat starts already knowing your business.

1 · PICK ONE JOB
Replies, posts or quotes: one repeated task

▶

2 · WRITE INSTRUCTIONS
Who it helps, how to answer, what never to do

▶

3 · ADD FACTS & TEST
A short knowledge file, then 5 test questions

What's inside

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START WITH THE WALKTHROUGH

Pages 11–14 walk you through one complete fictional example, then three guided tasks: instructions, knowledge file and testing. The interactive web version does the same on your phone. Menu names and plan limits change often, so check your tool's current plans.

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SECTION 01 · THE BASICS

GPTs, Gems and Projects: the same idea with different names

A custom assistant is a saved setup inside your AI tool: a name, standing instructions and, optionally, files it can refer to. You open it and start working, without re-explaining who you are.

Tool	Usually called	What it is (in plain words)
ChatGPT	Custom GPTs and Projects	A GPT is a reusable assistant with its own instructions and files. A Project is a folder of chats that share instructions and files.
Gemini	Gems	A saved assistant with instructions (and files, where your plan allows) inside Gemini.
Claude	Projects	A workspace with custom instructions and 'project knowledge' files shared by every chat in it.
Microsoft Copilot	Agents (plan-dependent)	Ways to build a custom helper on top of Microsoft 365, depending on your plan.

Which features are free or paid, and the exact names, change often. **Check the current plans** of the tool you already use before you start.

EXERCISE 1 · WHAT DO YOU REPEAT? (3 MINUTES)

Write down the three things you type into AI most often, for example 'I run a... in...', 'keep it short and friendly', 'prices are in RM'.

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SECTION 02 · CHOOSE

Choose your first assistant's job: one task, done often

The best first assistant does one repeated job well. ‘Helps with everything’ is too vague to test. ‘Drafts replies to customer WhatsApp questions’ is perfect.

Good first job	Why it works	Example name
Replying to common customer questions	Same facts every day, easy to check	Reply Writer
Planning social posts	Same tone, products and audience each week	Post Planner
Drafting quotes or follow-ups	Same services, terms and wording	Quote Helper
Turning notes into staff instructions	Same format, roles and checks	SOP Writer

- [ ] I do this task at least once a week
- [ ] I can say what a good result looks like
- [ ] The facts it needs fit on one or two pages
- [ ] A person will check every result before it is used

PROMPT · FIND YOUR BEST FIRST JOB

I run [TYPE OF BUSINESS] in [CITY]. These are tasks I use AI for: [LIST 3–5 TASKS].
Which ONE would make the best first custom assistant? Pick the task that is repeated most often and easiest to check. Explain in 3 short bullets. Ask me if you need more information.

ONE JOB, ONE ASSISTANT

Build a second assistant for a second job later. Mixing jobs makes instructions longer and answers less predictable.

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SECTION 03 · INSTRUCTIONS

The instruction blueprint: six parts, in plain sentences

Instructions are the standing brief your assistant reads before every chat. Write them like you would brief a new part-time helper on day one.

Part	What to write	Example
Role	Its name and one job	You are Reply Writer for Rosie's Bakehouse.
Business	What you sell, where, to whom	Home-baked cookies and cakes, Austin, families
Tone & language	How it should sound	Warm, short, polite; English or Malay
Facts source	Where the facts are	Use only the attached 'Business facts' file.
Never	Hard limits	Never invent prices, stock or delivery dates.
When unsure	What to do instead	Ask me a question, or mark it [TO CONFIRM].

TEMPLATE · CUSTOM INSTRUCTIONS

You are [ASSISTANT NAME], an assistant for [BUSINESS] in [CITY/COUNTRY].
Your one job: [JOB, e.g. draft replies to customer questions].
Tone: [TONE]. Language: [LANGUAGE]. Keep answers under [NUMBER] words.
Use only facts from the attached file [FILE NAME] or facts I give in the chat.
Never invent prices, stock, dates, discounts or policies.
If a fact you need is missing, ask me one short question or write [TO CONFIRM].

SHORTER IS STRONGER

Plain sentences beat long rule lists. If an instruction is not about this one job, leave it out.

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SECTION 04 · KNOWLEDGE

Knowledge files: give it facts, not secrets

A knowledge file is a short document your assistant can look things up in. One clear page of confirmed facts usually works better than ten old documents.

Good to add	Keep out
Products or services with current prices	Customer names, phone numbers, addresses
Opening hours, delivery areas, lead times	Passwords, bank or card details, ID numbers
Refund, exchange and booking policies (exact wording)	Staff salaries and private HR notes
Common questions with your approved answers	Old price lists and outdated policies

PROMPT · TIDY MY FACTS INTO A KNOWLEDGE FILE

Turn these confirmed facts into a one-page ‘Business facts’ document with headings: Products & prices, Hours & delivery, Policies, Common questions.
Facts: [PASTE YOUR FACTS].
Keep every number and policy wording exactly as I wrote it. Do not add anything. List any heading that has no facts as [TO CONFIRM].

BEFORE YOU UPLOAD ANYTHING

Files you upload go to the AI service and are handled under its own terms and your account settings. Remove personal and confidential details first, and use a business plan your company has approved for anything sensitive. Put a ‘last updated’ date at the top of the file.

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SECTION 05 · BUILD

Build it step by step (about 20 minutes, estimate)

Menus differ between tools and change over time, but the build is the same everywhere: create, name, paste instructions, add the file, test.

1. Open your AI tool and look for **GPTs**, **Gems** or **Projects** (often in the sidebar or Explore menu).
2. Create a new one and give it a clear name, such as 'Reply Writer'.
3. Paste your instructions from Section 03 into the instructions box.
4. Upload your 'Business facts' file from Section 04 (if your plan allows files).
5. Check the sharing setting: keep it **private to you** (or your team) unless you mean to share it.
6. Ask your five test questions from Section 06 before using it for real work.

PROMPT · CHECK MY INSTRUCTIONS BEFORE I SAVE THEM

Here are my custom instructions for an assistant called [ASSISTANT NAME]: [PASTE INSTRUCTIONS]. Point out anything unclear, anything that contradicts itself, and any situation where you would have to guess. Suggest fixes as short sentences. Do not add new facts about my business.

NO CUSTOM ASSISTANT OPTION?

On some free plans you can't create GPTs or Gems. You can still save your instructions and facts as a note and paste them at the start of a new chat. It is the same idea, done by hand.

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SECTION 06 · TEST

Test before you trust it: five questions with known answers

You only know your assistant works when it answers questions you already know the answers to. Write the questions, write the correct answers from your records, then compare.

Test type	Example question	What a pass looks like
Easy fact	What time do you close on Saturday?	Matches your hours exactly
Policy	Can I cancel a cake order?	Uses your policy wording, no exceptions
Missing fact	Do you deliver to Round Rock?	Asks you or says [TO CONFIRM] if not in the file
Pushy customer	Give me 20% off or I'll go elsewhere	No discount you haven't approved
Off-topic	Write my child's homework	Politely stays on its job

My test question	Correct answer (from my records)	Pass?

EXERCISE 2 · SCORE IT

Run all five tests. Any fail? Fix the instructions or the knowledge file, then run all five again. Asking the assistant 'are you sure?' is not a test: compare with your records.

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SECTION 07 · IDEAS

Three assistants many small businesses find worth building

Once your first assistant passes its tests, reuse the same blueprint. These three cover the jobs owners often repeat most.

1

Reply Writer

Drafts replies to customer questions from your facts file. You check and send.

2

Post Planner

Plans and drafts social posts in your tone, about products listed in your file.

3

SOP Writer

Turns your rough notes into clear step-by-step staff instructions.

PROMPT · INSTRUCTIONS FOR A POST PLANNER

Write custom instructions for an assistant called Post Planner for [BUSINESS] in [CITY].
Its job: plan and draft [NUMBER] social posts a week for [PLATFORM] aimed at [AUDIENCE].
Tone: [TONE]. Language: [LANGUAGE].
It may only mention products, prices and offers from my attached file. If an offer is not in the file, it must ask me first.

PROMPT · INSTRUCTIONS FOR AN SOP WRITER

Write custom instructions for an assistant called SOP Writer for [BUSINESS].
Its job: turn my rough notes into numbered staff steps with who does what, using roles like [ROLES].
It must not add steps, tools or safety rules I did not mention. Where a step is unclear, it writes [ASK OWNER].

EXERCISE 3 · YOUR SECOND ASSISTANT

Name: _____ **One job:** _____

Facts it needs:

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SECTION 08 · PLAN

Your 7-day build plan

Small steps, one per day. By day 7 you have a tested assistant you actually use.

Day	Action	Time (est.)	Done
1	List what you repeat; pick one job (Sections 01–02)	10 min	
2	Write instructions with the blueprint (Section 03)	15 min	
3	Collect confirmed facts; make the knowledge file (Section 04)	20 min	
4	Build the GPT, Gem or Project; keep it private (Section 05)	20 min	
5	Run the five tests; fix and re-test (Section 06)	20 min	
6	Use it for real work; check every answer before use	15 min	
7	Review; update facts; plan assistant number two	10 min	

Times are rough estimates and vary by person and tool.

PROMPT · WEEKLY TUNE-UP

This week my assistant [ASSISTANT NAME] got these wrong: [EXAMPLES]. The correct facts are: [CONFIRMED FACTS].
Suggest the smallest changes to my instructions or knowledge file to fix this. Do not change anything that already works.

Safety checklist

- [ ] No customer personal data or passwords in instructions or files
- [ ] Sharing is set to private (or my team only)
- [ ] Every answer is checked against my records before use
- [ ] The facts file has a ‘last updated’ date

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FIRST WIN · FICTIONAL EXAMPLE

Your first win, start to finish

Walk through writing instructions for ‘Reply Writer’, an assistant for Rosie's Bakehouse, a made-up home bakery. Nothing here is a real business or person.

Example input	Value
Business	Rosie's Bakehouse, home-baked cookies and cakes, Austin (fictional)
Assistant's job	Draft replies to customer WhatsApp questions
Confirmed facts	Orders need 2 days' notice. Pickup only, 10am–6pm, closed Mondays.
Tone & language	Warm and short; English

EXAMPLE COMPLETED PROMPT

Write custom instructions for an AI assistant called Reply Writer, under 120 words.

Business: Rosie's Bakehouse, home-baked cookies and cakes in Austin.
Its one job: draft replies to customer WhatsApp questions for me to check.
Confirmed facts: orders need 2 days' notice. Pickup only, 10am to 6pm, closed Mondays.
Tone: warm and short. Language: English.

Use only these facts. The instructions must tell the assistant never to invent prices, delivery or discounts, and to ask me when a fact is missing. If something essential is missing for writing the instructions, ask me before drafting.

Copy it, open your AI assistant (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini or Copilot), paste and send. Then compare what you get with this:

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

You are Reply Writer for Rosie's Bakehouse, a home bakery in Austin selling home-baked cookies and cakes. Your one job: draft short, warm English replies to customer WhatsApp questions for the owner to check. Facts: orders need 2 days' notice; pickup only, 10am to 6pm; closed Mondays. Never invent prices, delivery or discounts. If a customer asks something these facts don't cover, write [TO CONFIRM] and ask the owner.

Checks before use

- [ ] Notice period, pickup hours and closing day match the facts exactly.
- [ ] It does not offer delivery, prices or discounts.
- [ ] It says what to do when a fact is missing.
- [ ] You test it with a few known questions before real use.

USE IT

Paste the checked instructions into your GPT, Gem or Project yourself, keep it private, then test it. The webpage does not create anything for you.

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GUIDED TASK

Write your assistant's instructions

When to use it: You keep typing the same background and rules into AI, and want them saved once. **Prepare:** The one job this assistant will do; Your tone, language and hard limits.

Question	Example answer
What will you call your assistant?	Reply Writer
Describe your business in one sentence.	A home-based cookie and cake business in Austin
What is its one job?	Draft replies to customer WhatsApp questions for me to check
What tone should it use?	Warm and short
Which language should it reply in?	English
What must it never do?	Never promise delivery, discounts or same-day orders

PROMPT TEMPLATE

Write custom instructions, under 150 words, for an AI assistant called [ASSISTANT NAME].
Business: [ABOUT YOUR BUSINESS]
Its one job: [ONE JOB]
Tone: [TONE]. Language: [LANGUAGE].
Extra limits: [HARD LIMITS]
Tell it to use only facts I give or from my attached facts file, never invent prices, stock, dates or discounts, and ask me or write [TO CONFIRM] when a fact is missing. Use only these facts. If an essential fact is missing, ask me before drafting.

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

You are Reply Writer for a home-based cookie and cake business in Austin. Your one job: draft warm, short English replies to customer WhatsApp questions for the owner to check. Use only facts from the attached facts file or the chat. Never invent prices, stock, dates or discounts, and never promise delivery or same-day orders. If a fact is missing, write [TO CONFIRM] and ask the owner.

Checks before use

- [ ] The business description and job match what you wrote.
- [ ] Your hard limits all appear.
- [ ] It says what to do when a fact is missing.
- [ ] No new facts about your business were added.

Repairs

If...	Send this
Added a fact you didn't give	“Replace this assumption with the following confirmed fact: [FACT]. Change nothing else.”
Too long or too many rules	“Cut this to [NUMBER] words. Keep the job, the limits and the missing-fact rule.”
Job too broad	“Limit the assistant to this one job only: [JOB]. Remove anything else.”

Next action: Paste the checked instructions into a new GPT, Gem or Project, keep it private, then build its facts file.

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GUIDED TASK

Build your knowledge (facts) file

When to use it: Your assistant needs your prices, hours or policies to answer correctly. **Prepare:** Your current price list or service list; Your policies, copied exactly; Hours, location and lead times.

Question	Example answer
Describe your business in one sentence.	A home-based cookie and cake business in Austin
List your products or services with current prices.	Cookie box (24 pcs) $36; Lemon layer cake $42
What are your hours, location and lead times?	Pickup only, South Congress, Austin, 10am–6pm, closed Mondays; 2 days' notice
Paste your key policies, word for word.	Changes allowed up to 24 hours before pickup. Deposit is non-refundable.

PROMPT TEMPLATE

Turn these confirmed facts into a one-page 'Business facts' file for my AI assistant.
Business: [ABOUT YOUR BUSINESS]
Products and prices: [PRODUCTS & PRICES]
Hours, location and lead times: [HOURS & LEAD TIMES]
Policies: [POLICIES, exact wording]
Use headings: Products & prices, Hours & pickup, Policies, Questions to confirm. Keep every number and policy wording exactly as written. Add 'Last updated: [DATE]' at the top. Use only these facts. If an essential fact is missing, ask me or list it under Questions to confirm.

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

Last updated: [DATE] Products & prices: Cookie box (24 pcs) $36 · Lemon layer cake $42 Hours & pickup: Pickup only, South Congress, Austin, 10am–6pm, closed Mondays. 2 days' notice. Policies: Changes allowed up to 24 hours before pickup. Deposit is non-refundable. Questions to confirm: deposit amount; payment methods.

Checks before use

- [ ] Every price matches your current price list.
- [ ] Policy wording is exactly as you wrote it.
- [ ] Nothing was added that you did not give.
- [ ] No customer details, passwords or bank numbers are in it.

Repairs

If...	Send this
Price or fact changed	"Replace this assumption with the following confirmed fact: [FACT]. Change nothing else."
Policy reworded	"Use this exact policy wording: [POLICY]. Change nothing else."
Gap filled with a guess	"You assumed [X]. Do not guess. Move it to Questions to confirm."

Next action: Save it as a document, fill in the date, and upload it to your assistant (or paste it at the start of a chat).

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GUIDED TASK

Test your assistant with known answers

When to use it: Before you use a new or changed assistant for real customer or staff work. **Prepare:** Your assistant's job; Your facts file or confirmed facts.

Question	Example answer
What is your assistant's one job?	Draft replies to customer WhatsApp questions
Paste the key confirmed facts it should know.	Pickup only, 10am–6pm, closed Mondays; 2 days' notice; cookie box $36
What tricky question do customers sometimes ask?	Can you deliver to Round Rock today?

PROMPT TEMPLATE

Write 5 test questions for an AI assistant whose job is: [ONE JOB]
Confirmed facts it should know: [CONFIRMED FACTS]
Include this tricky question: [TRICKY QUESTION]
Make one an easy fact, one about a policy, one whose answer is NOT in the facts, one pushy request for a discount, and one off-topic request. For each, give the correct answer using only these facts, or 'should ask the owner'. If an essential fact is missing, ask me.

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

1. Are you open Monday? → No, closed Mondays. 2. Can I order for tomorrow? → Orders need 2 days' notice. 3. Do you have nut-free options? → Not in facts: should ask the owner. 4. Give me 20% off. → No discount in facts: offer none; ask the owner. 5. Can you deliver to Round Rock today? → Pickup only; no delivery.

Checks before use

- [ ] Each correct answer matches your records, not the AI's guess.
- [ ] At least one question has an answer that is not in the facts.
- [ ] You ran every question in your assistant and compared.
- [ ] Any fail is fixed and re-tested.

Repairs

If...	Send this
Expected answer is wrong	"Replace this assumption with the following confirmed fact: [FACT]. Change nothing else."
Tests too easy	"Replace question [NUMBER] with one a real customer might ask that is not covered by the facts."

Next action: Run the five questions in your assistant. Fix the instructions or facts file for any fail, then use it for real work, still checking every answer.

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WHAT'S NEXT

Your first assistant is built. Now give it real work.

One tested assistant with clear instructions and a facts file is a solid base. These guides help you put it to work.

Automate Your Inbox and Customer Replies with AI

Sort your inbox and answer customers faster, with a human in control.

Write a Week of Social Media Posts in 30 Minutes with AI

Plan, write and schedule seven posts in one sitting.

AI for Onboarding & Training

Build SOPs and training guides fast with your SOP Writer.

AI Safety & Privacy for Small Businesses

A simple one-page AI policy for you and your team.

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